



All In premium newsletter - No. 1 - Draft for review

Stop Arguing With What Has Already Happened

Subject: Where are you today, honestly?

Preview text: *One question, one exercise, one ten-minute step.*

Dear friend,

Think about this for a moment. A man closes the business he ran for eleven years. Ask him how he is, and he will tell you he is fine. Good, even. He will list the silver linings like items on an invoice. And then, right at the end, quietly, will come the truest thing he says all day: "I don't know who I am without it."

He is an example - but you have probably met a version of him, in someone you know, or in the mirror.

And that quiet sentence is not an ending. It is where bouncing forward begins.

THE HONEST QUESTION

Every one of these letters starts in the same place. Before you read on, answer this in one sentence: *Where am I today?* Not where you should be. Not where you tell people you are. Where you actually are. Nobody will read it but you.



If the honest answer is hard to find, try three quick tests.

The body test. What is your body telling you - how are you sleeping, eating, breathing?

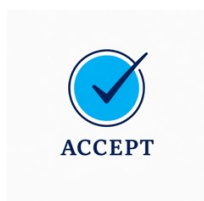
The avoidance test. Which person, topic or task have you quietly been steering around this week?

The out-loud test. Say your sentence aloud. If it sounds like something you would announce rather than something you would admit, it is not the honest one yet.

And remember: a feeling does not need to be fixed before it can be named. Naming it is the work.



THIS MONTH ON THE PATH: ACCEPT



Accept is the first step on your Path, and the most misunderstood. Accepting does not mean approving of what happened. It does not mean pretending it doesn't hurt, and it does not mean giving up. It means you stop spending your strength arguing with what has already happened, so your strength is free for what comes next.

THE EXERCISE

Take a page. Draw a line down the middle.

On the left, write what happened. Facts only - what a camera would have seen.

On the right, write what you tell yourself about it - what it means, whose fault it is, what it says about you.

Then read the left side again. Most of the pain sits on the right. Your next step sits on the left. The Walking Pages, attached, give you the page.

THE TEN-MINUTE STEP

Pick one fact from your left column - the one you have been avoiding. Say it out loud to one person you trust. This is your first step in bouncing forward. From here forward.

A CLOSING THOUGHT

Nothing changes while we are still arguing with what has already happened. The moment we stop, everything can.

Until next month,

Maher

Setbacks don't get the last word.